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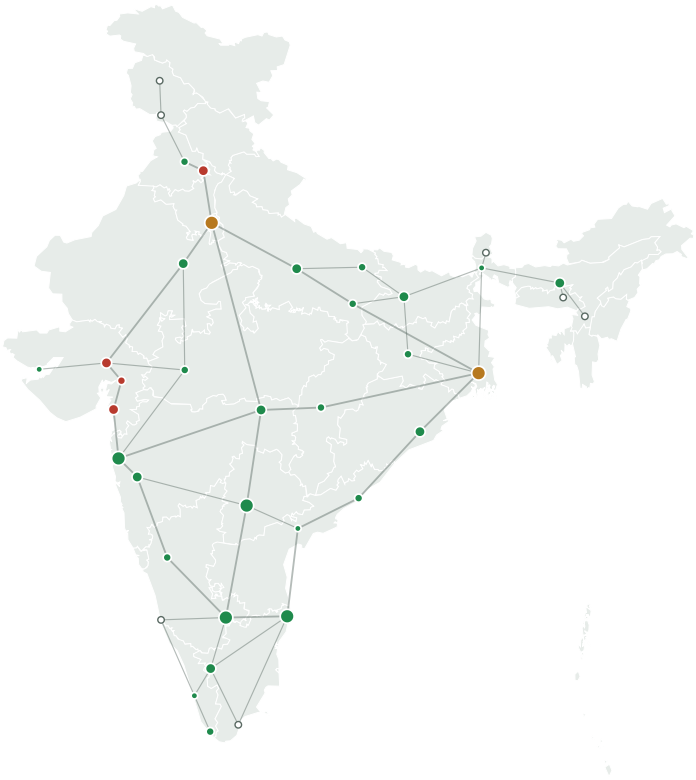
Truck rents rise on India's main corridors before Diwali's restart

● NETWORK: AMBER

DIWALI WEEK · DIWALI TODAY

For heads of logistics moving goods within, into or out of India, wherever they sit: what to move, hold or reroute this week.

With Diwali today, the freight risk sits in the week after it. October moved a record number of loads and truck rents rose on every main run[1,2], and Shriram Finance expects that pull to last until mid-November[3]. With Gujarat and Kolkata stopping for festivals this week, I'd expect late truck bookings to wait or pay more.



Map: DataMeet, CC BY 4.0

● GREEN normal for the week: busy, but plans hold
● AMBER something slows freight beyond a normal week
● RED freight largely stopped across a state, corridor or gateway

DATES THAT MATTER

- **Since Sun 1 Nov** Delhi admits outside goods vehicles only if BS-VI, CNG, LNG or electric[4]
- **Since Fri 6 Nov** Delhi-NCR on Stage III of GRAP, its pollution action plan[5]
- **Until Thu 12 Nov** Pune's old-city markets take goods vehicles only at night
- **Sun 8 Nov** Kolkata keeps goods vehicles off its roads for Kali Puja
- **Mon 9 – Wed 11 Nov** Kolkata curbs goods vehicles for the immersions
- **Tue 10 – Sat 14 Nov** Gujarat's markets and transport shut till Labh Pancham

DELIVERY PROMISE BY REGION

North	West	South	East	Northeast	Central
+0	+0	+0	+0	+0	+0
GREEN	GREEN	GREEN	GREEN	GREEN	GREEN

* Likely extra days on freight within the region this week, to Sun 15 Nov, on the places named, against a normal week.

Odisha's Kalinga ghat road into Kandhamal opened to all vehicles on Saturday after 46 days shut[6]. Central India and the rest of the South and East run as the season does, with nothing reported slowing freight beyond it.

A record October pushes truck rents up on every main run, Delhi–Kolkata most

North, East, West, South, Northeast · The Delhi–Kolkata, Bengaluru–Mumbai and Kolkata–Guwahati truck runs, and the factory belts at either end

GREEN · MEDIUM COST OF DELAY · HIGH CONFIDENCE

Businesses raised 156.21 million e-way bills in October, the GST permits that travel with goods loads, a record and 23% more than a year earlier, GSTN figures show[1]. Shriram Finance's monthly bulletin puts truck rents up on every route it tracks against last October: 13% on Delhi–Kolkata, 12% on Bengaluru–Mumbai and 9% on Kolkata–Guwahati[2]. Its commercial-vehicle head expects festive loads to keep that pull going until the middle of November[3].

- **Delhi–Kolkata, on NH-19** North · +0 days The steepest rise of the three. Loads still move, at the higher rate. The bit that worries me is the first week after Diwali, when factories around Delhi and Kolkata restart together. I'd expect a truck booked late then to cost more rather than leave late.
- **Bengaluru–Mumbai, on NH-48** South · +0 days Trucks run the whole road this week, so loads move on time. I'd expect the higher rate to hold until mid-November on loads both ways, into Mumbai's warehouse belt and back.
- **Kolkata–Guwahati, through the Siliguri corridor** Northeast · +0 days The Northeast's road link runs through the narrow Siliguri corridor, so there are few other trucks to call on. I'd expect loads to Guwahati to pay the higher rate rather than wait.

DECISIONS TO MAKE

For freight within India

- Book trucks now for the first loads after Diwali on these three runs; Shriram sees no easing before mid-November, so waiting is unlikely to buy a lower rate (my estimate).
- Plan Gujarat and Kolkata loads around this week's festival stops; a truck held at a shut dock is a truck lost to the rest of the plan.

For freight into and out of India

- Export hauls from Bengaluru's factories to Nhava Sheva ride the Bengaluru–Mumbai road; price this week's quotes at the higher truck rate.

SOURCES

1. Daijiworld: E-way bill generation hits record 156.21 million in October, 7 Nov
2. Autocar Professional: Truck rentals rise as festive demand drives October vehicle sales (Shriram Mobility Bulletin), 5 Nov
3. Business News Week: Festive demand keeps truck rentals strong, Shriram Mobility Bulletin, 5 Nov
4. ETV Bharat: Delhi turns away BS-IV vehicles for a second day, 2 Nov
5. The Statesman: GRAP-III restrictions enforced across NCR ahead of Diwali, 6 Nov
6. OdishaBytes: Kalinga Ghat in Odisha reopens after 46 days, 7 Nov